SOUL SHARE

An Empowerment in Social Networking Service

A Product Thinking Case Study on Instagram

Introduction

Instagram is a free online photo and short form video sharing app and social networking service owned by Meta platforms, launched on October 6th, 2010.

It’s purposeful to opt as:

- It influences high engagement rates.
- Relation between brands and users.
- Huge and potential Audience.
- Marketing Campaigns generate maximum sales.

Vision

“To capture and share the world's moments, fostering a sense of global community and connection.”

The main aim is to:

- Connect through valued experiences.
- Encompass diverse cultures and perspectives.
- Create a sense of belonging.
- Aspiring user participation.

Mission

“To enhance user experience through continuous innovation and expansion of its features.”

It currently focuses on

- Building community and connecting people.
- Foster creativity.
- Evolving features.
- Safe and security.

Problem Statement

“When I share on Instagram, I want to connect and reach others safely, but I struggle with privacy risks and outages, leading to frustration.”

These issues are currently arises due to:

- Scams due to fake ads and identity risks.
- Poor platform transparency.
- Algorithm changes or unwanted feed leading to engagement drops.
- Confidential risks.

Jobs to be done

“when I share my life moments, I want to feel safe and connect easily so that I can truly belong and valued.”

The users mainly hire instagram for:

- Share photos, videos and stories instantly as a functional job.
- Feel safe, entertained and relaxed as a emotional job.
- Gain recognition, likes, followers and to look relevant and trendy as a social job.

User Research plan

The combined approach of Qualitative and Quantitative analysis will help to validate the problems faced by users as:

Interviews (Qualitative Analysis) focus to determine

❖ User behavior and frustration.

❖ Affect of unwanted feed.

❖ User perception and willingness.

Surveys(Quantitative Analysis) helps to reveal

❖ Privacy risks.

❖ User satisfaction and engagement.

❖ Prioritizing features.

User Persona - 1

Miff Maya

Bio: 29-year-old fitness influencer relies on Instagram for income, brand collaborations, and audience engagement.

Goals & Motivations:

- Grow audience and maintain high engagement.
- Collaborate with brands for income.
- Inspire people with fitness content.

Pains & Frustrations:

- Algorithm changes reduce reach and engagement.
- Account restrictions without clear reason.
- Constant pressure to adapt to platform's updates.

Quote:
"My career depends on Instagram, but I can't trust the algorithm anymore."

User Persona - 2

Reliable Riya

Bio: 27-year-old marketing professional loves sharing travel and lifestyle updates but is very cautious about online privacy.

Goals & Motivations:

- Share experiences without risking privacy.
- Connect only with trusted friends and communities.
- Avoid scams, harassment, and unwanted exposure.

Pains & Frustrations:

- Worries about data misuse and tracking.
- Concerned about scam ads, fake accounts, and phishing DMs.
- Feels Instagram's safety tools are not transparent to use.

Quote:

"I want to enjoy Instagram without constantly worrying about my safety online."

Customer Journey Map

Customer journey map	Awareness	Consideration	Onboarding	Retention	Loyalty
User actions	Heard about app	Read reviews	Creates account	Posts & engages	Decide to share
Touch points	Ads, friends	Blogs, forums	Sign up	Stories, DM, explore	Word of mouth, daily use
Experience	Curious but cautious	Wants trust	Excited but confused	Connected but cautious	Based on safety trust
Pain points	Doubts on safety	Finds scam and fake ads	Complex privacy setting	Scam ads, fake DM	Hesitant to recommend
Opportunities	Show safety first in ads	Share clear safety proof	Simple privacy set up	Strong detection and reporting	Build trust and reliability

Key pain points

- Confusing privacy and security settings.
- Frequent scam ads, fake accounts.
- Low trust in safety measures.
- Frequent outages or connection unavailability.

Opportunity Sizing

Assumptions:

choosing bottom up approach for sizing opportunity,

- Instagram has a total of 500 million users around the Globe.
- Users concerned about privacy, security and scams may contribute to 60% of the total users i.e., 300 million
- Penetration Goal is 70% of those 300 million in 3 years i.e., 210 million.

A powerful opportunity of 210 million around the world to build trust, engagement and loyalty is available.

Prioritization

Applying Moscow Prioritization framework, we have:

Must have: Confusing privacy setting, frequent scam ads and fake accounts.

Should have: Low trust in safety measures.

Could have: frequent outages or connection unavailability.

Won’t have: None

Minimum Viable Product

The Features of desired MVP to solve the prioritized pain points might be:

- Simplified Privacy setup wizard.
- Scam and fake detection layer.
- Safety check ups and security tips.

Road Map

A Goal based road map could be described as follows:

Quarter 1: Launch simple privacy set up that reduce user confusion.

Quarter 2: Launch scam and report detection layer that safeguards users by block and report mechanism

Quarter 3: Launch safety Dashboard that establish trust and loyalty.

AI Thinking

AI Thinking will resolve:

- Detection of unusual activity with clear, privacy settings.
- Recommends safe communication boosting user confidence.
- Predictive prevention of server overloads and reroute traffic.
- Capable to identify scams faster than humans.

References

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